WAHKIAKUM COMMON GROUND

Success Story: Nelson Creek

This restoration project involved building a new channel-spanning bridge on Nelson Creek Road and reconnecting Nelson Creek with its floodplain. As a result, the project improved habitat connectivity for fish and wildlife, restored a more natural flow, and reduced flooding.

PROBLEM: The creek was in a roadside ditch and several culverts had failed resulting in flooding of the road and private property, as well as poor fish passage.

PARTNERS: Columbia Land Trust worked with the neighboring landowners and Wahkiakum County Public Works.

SOLUTIONS: Columbia Land Trust acquired the floodplain property, constructed a new seismic-ready bridge and planted 180,000 native trees and shrubs.

Want to know more? Visit https://beav.es/WCG

Wahkiakum County MRC

WAHKIAKUM COMMON GROUND

Success Story: Nelson Creek

CHALLENGES: Multi-year planning and partnerships helped address maintenance burdens and budget limitations for the county, and permitting timelines.

BENEFITS: Excavation of new floodplain channels and stream realignment helped reconnect the floodplain, reducing flooding on Nelson Creek Road and private lands.

LESSONS LEARNED

Long-term solutions require partnerships and multi-agency coordination. Upfront investment reduces long-term maintenance costs and results in cost-savings for the county. Restoration projects can address both ecological goals and longstanding infrastructure challenges.

PROJECT PARTNERS & FUNDERS

Columbia Land Trust
Private Landowners
Wahkiakum County Public Works
Columbia Estuary Ecosystem Restoration Program
Columbia River Estuary Study Taskforce (CREST)
Bonneville Power Authority

***Wahkiakum County** relies on a healthy salmon fishery for commercial, tribal, and recreational purposes, yet salmon populations are threatened. Efforts to support sustainable fisheries by restoring watersheds also have benefits for the community: reducing risk from coastal hazards, boosting economic vitality, and improving emergency preparedness.*

To learn about multi-benefit watershed restoration **SUCCESS STORIES** in Wahkiakum County or to **get involved** visit:

https://beav.es/WCG